

Chicken Gyro Recipe

PREP: 15 MINS | COOK: 10 MINS | MARINATE: 30 MINS

"A vibrant Greek classic straight from The Mediterranean Dish. The secret tool here is full-fat Greek yogurt, which beautifully tenderizes lean chicken tenderloins while locking in bold aromatics, lemon juice, red wine vinegar, and earthy spices."

INGREDIENTS

CHICKEN GYRO MARINADE

- **1½ lbs** chicken tenderloins
(or chicken breast / thighs)
- **1 cup** plain Greek yogurt
(whole milk preferred)
- **1 large** lemon (juiced)
- **2 tbsp** extra virgin olive oil (+ 1 tbsp for skillet)
- **2 tbsp** red wine vinegar
- **3 cloves** garlic (minced)
- **1 tbsp** dried Greek oregano
- **1 tsp** sweet paprika
- **1 tsp** ground cumin
- **1 tsp** ground coriander
- **1 pinch** cayenne pepper (optional kick)
- Kosher salt and black pepper (to taste)

FOR SERVING & ASSEMBLY

- **4 to 6** Greek pita breads
- **1 cup** Tzatziki sauce
- **1 large** tomato (sliced)
- **1** cucumber (sliced)
- **1** green bell pepper (cored and sliced)
- **1 small** red onion (halved and sliced)
- Pitted Kalamata olives

INSTRUCTIONS

STEP 1: WHISK THE MARINADE

In a large mixing bowl, combine the plain Greek yogurt, lemon juice, 2 tablespoons of extra virgin olive oil, and red wine vinegar. Whisk in the minced garlic, dried oregano, sweet paprika, ground cumin, ground coriander, a generous pinch of kosher salt, black pepper, and optional cayenne pepper until fully emulsified.

STEP 2: MARINATE THE CHICKEN

Add the chicken pieces to the marinade bowl. Toss thoroughly, ensuring each piece is uniformly and heavily coated with the seasoned yogurt mixture. Cover tightly and transfer to the refrigerator to marinate for 30 minutes, or up to overnight. (*Note: If you are in an absolute hurry, you can proceed straight to cooking without refrigeration.*)

STEP 3: SEAR THE CHICKEN

Heat roughly 1 tablespoon of olive oil in a heavy non-stick skillet or cast-iron pan over medium-high heat until glistening but not smoking. Pull the chicken from the bowl, shaking off any loose, excessive drippings. Arrange the chicken in a flat, single layer. Let cook undisturbed for about 5 minutes until heavily browned and beautifully charred, then turn with tongs and cook for another 5 minutes until fully cooked through to an internal temperature of 165°F.

STEP 4: WARM PITAS & ASSEMBLE

Quickly warm your pita flatbreads over an open medium gas burner flame or inside a hot, completely dry skillet until warm and pliable. Transfer a warm pita to your serving plate, slather a thick dollop of tzatziki sauce down the spine, and top with 2 to 3 strips of seared chicken. Top with fresh tomato, cucumber, green pepper, sharp red onion, and a sprinkle of Kalamata olives. Fold over tightly and enjoy!

ALTERNATE COOKING METHODS

To Grill Outdoors: Fire up your grill to medium heat. Cook the marinated tenders for 5 minutes on one side, flip, and grill for 3 to 5 more minutes until fully done.

To Oven-Bake: Heat your oven to 375°F. Arrange chicken tenders on a parchment-lined sheet pan and bake for approximately 20 minutes until the internal temperature registers 165°F.